

Knowledge Organiser (GROW W8): Finding places in an atlas

Humanities Aut 1 · 2026–27 · Workbook outcome: Locate countries, continents and oceans on a map/atlas.

Key Word	Definition
Modelled:	Modelled: I take a card. I read the name. I look it up in the index. The index tells me the page and the grid reference, and it tells me what kind of place it is. Then I sort the card.
Decided together:	Decided together: the card names a country, so we have a name, so we take the index route. Three steps and we are on the square.

Key Facts

- A map shows you where. An atlas is a book of maps with a way in.
- Next to the page number is a grid reference, like 14 C3.

Arrival Task

Retrieving what an atlas is for

1) A map shows you where. An atlas is a book of maps with a way in.

2) Next to the page number is a grid reference, like 14 C3.

Two ways of finding the same place

Two ways of finding the same country. Way A: turn pages until you see it. Way B: look it up in the index, go to that page, and use the grid reference.

Try it: take the card in front of you. Do you know its name? Then the index is your route. Do not open the map yet.

We Do 1: Sort the cards, then match each to its grid reference

Card 1: a country. Which continent is it inside?

Card 2: an ocean. Which continents does it lie between?

Card 3: a continent. How many countries can you find on its page?

We Do 2: Match each card to the route that finds it

We match one card as a class. Everyone writes their route on a whiteboard, then we hold up the boards at the same time. The card for this one is the ocean. You have a name, so which route? Write it and hold.

Scaffolding – Stretch

Word Bank

Modelled:, Decided together:, Space, Voice, Audience, Influence

Your route

All twelve sorted and referenced, plus which route you used for each and why.

Sentence frames

"Who ... what they do ... so that ..." | "... because ..."



Reference Zone — keep this beside your work

The model

Modelled: I take a card. I read the name. I look it up in the index. The index tells me the page and the grid reference, and it tells me what kind of place it is. Then I sort the card.

Decided together: the card names a country, so we have a name, so we take the index route. Three steps and we are on the square.

Check yourself

- Check yourself: did you check the index rather than working from memory?
- Check yourself: does every card have a page and a grid reference?
- Check yourself: is each country written next to the continent it sits inside?

From the lesson sheet

Finding places in an atlas

SoW: 'GROW Weekly - Autumn'!C53 — "Locate countries, continents and oceans on a map/atlas."

Learning objective: I can sort places into continents, oceans and countries, and find each one in the atlas by page and grid reference.

No personal or family history is required. Every task uses the class atlas and the supplied place cards.

Locating record

Name → index → page → grid reference. Say which route you used.

The first row is done for you, from the card we located together. It is in italics so you know it is not yours.

Independent Work – Stretch

Twelve sorted and referenced, with the route named for each.

All twelve sorted and referenced, plus which route you used for each and why.

Card	Continent, ocean or country	Page and grid	Route used
<i>a country card</i>	<i>country, inside its continent</i>	<i>p14 C3</i>	<i>index, because I had the name</i>

Choose a route

- 1. I chose my own route.
- 2. My references are my own work.
- 3. Any adult help is written on the record.

5 · Learner confirmation

I confirm this is my own work.

Learner name (print)	Signature
Date	

Exit Ticket – Stretch

1) Read one reference to a partner without saying the name. They find it and say what they landed on.

2) Did they land somewhere else? Change the page or the square so the reference says what you meant. That change is your influence.

3) That closes these eight weeks. Keep your record in your folder with the others.

Lundy Loop — this lesson

SPACE stays available. VOICE is received. AUDIENCE names back exactly. INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Space	is room to take part;
Voice	VOICE is received.
Audience	AUDIENCE names back exactly.
Influence	INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Finding places in an atlas — Feedback Sheet

Keep with your book / folder.

Pupil name:	Date:
WWW (What Went Well): 	
EBI (Even Better If): 	
Level worked at: Supported / Standard / Stretch	Evidence filed: Yes / Not yet
Authorship — what I chose or decided myself: 	
Support given — prepared / scribed / modelled / hand-over-hand: 	
Pupil response — my next step: 	